

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 5 · LIFE IN THE NEIGHBOURHOOD, CITY & SOCIAL LIFE

Reading

B2.1

Hazırlık Sonrası 9.

Building the City of Tomorrow · City Mouse, Country Mouse: Two Lives Compared

Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

1 Before you read

Make predictions before you read.

1. Look at the title. What do you think this text is going to describe?
2. What infrastructure do you think a new neighbourhood needs before people can live there comfortably?

Building the City of Tomorrow

- 1 Twenty years ago, the Riverside district of our city was a collection of empty warehouses and cracked pavements. Today, it is one of the most talked-about neighbourhoods in the country, and its transformation says a lot about how modern cities develop. Planners began by improving the basic infrastructure: they repaired the roads, buried the power lines underground, and built a light-rail line connecting Riverside directly to the city centre. Without reliable transport and utilities, they argued, no other improvement would matter.
- 2 Once the infrastructure was ready, new housing developments followed quickly, along with amenities that made the area genuinely liveable rather than just convenient: parks, a community centre, cycle paths, and a pedestrian-only high street lined with cafés and small shops. Local officials insist that the goal was never simply to attract wealthy new residents. "We wanted a mixed neighbourhood," explains city planner Deniz Aksoy, "so that teachers, nurses, and young families could still afford to live here, not only people working in the new tech offices nearby."
- 3 Not everyone is convinced the plan has fully worked. Rents have risen sharply since the light-rail line opened, and some long-term residents say they no longer recognise their own street. This pattern, sometimes called gentrification, has appeared in cities around the world whenever an area develops quickly. As a result, the council is now going to introduce rules requiring a percentage of affordable housing in every new development — a decision many hope will keep Riverside open to people from every background, not just those who can pay the highest rent.

259 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- What was the first step planners took in developing Riverside?
 - Building parks and a community centre
 - Improving basic infrastructure such as roads and power lines
 - Opening cafés and small shops
 - Deniz Aksoy says the goal was to create a _____ neighbourhood where different kinds of workers could afford to live.
 - What problem has appeared in Riverside since the light-rail line opened?
 - Too much green space
 - Sharply rising rents / gentrification
 - A shortage of tech offices
 - The council plans to require a percentage of affordable housing in future developments.

☐ Correct
 ☐ Incorrect
-
- Riverside is now considered one of the most talked-about _____ in the country.

3 After you read*Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Do you think gentrification is always a bad thing? Why or why not?

- Write one sentence describing an infrastructure change you would like to see in your own neighbourhood.

1 Before you read*Make predictions before you read.*

- Would you rather live in a city or a village? Why?

- What do you think are the biggest advantages of rural life compared to city life?

City Mouse, Country Mouse: Two Lives Compared

- Emre grew up in a small village of about six hundred people and moved to the capital for university five years ago. "The first thing that struck me was the noise," he says. "In my village, you could hear birds and almost nothing else. Here, there's always traffic, always people." Despite the constant noise and the long daily commute, Emre says he wouldn't go back permanently. "There are simply more opportunities here — more jobs, more courses, more things happening every single evening."

- 2 His sister Aylin made the opposite choice. After finishing her degree in the city, she returned to their home village to open a small café, even though most of her university friends thought she was making a mistake. "People assume rural life is boring," she says, "but I know almost everyone who walks through that door. My cost of living is much lower, and I'm not stuck in traffic for two hours a day." She admits, however, that some things are harder: the nearest hospital is forty minutes away, and there is only one bus a day to the nearest large town.
- 3 Researchers who study urban and rural lifestyles say that stories like Emre and Aylin's are becoming more common as remote work grows. While cities will probably remain centres of innovation and opportunity, rural areas are attracting a new kind of resident: people who want more space and a stronger sense of community, as long as they can still stay connected to city jobs through the internet. Whether this trend continues will depend partly on whether rural infrastructure — from broadband to healthcare — keeps improving fast enough to support it.

275 words

2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- Why does Emre say he prefers living in the city, despite the noise?
 - ☐ a Because his village has no internet
 - ☐ b Because the city offers more opportunities
 - ☐ c Because public transport is free
- Aylin opened a small _____ in her home village after finishing her degree.
- Aylin regrets moving back to the village and wants to return to the city. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- According to researchers, what is helping some people choose rural life?
 - ☐ a The growth of remote work
 - ☐ b A shortage of city housing
 - ☐ c A new law about village life
- Aylin says the nearest hospital is about _____ minutes away from her village.

3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

- Whose choice do you find more convincing, Emre's or Aylin's? Why?
- Write one sentence comparing your own ideal lifestyle to Emre's or Aylin's.